32nd Edition

August 2024

Bionic Beats!

A Monthly Publication





Valpo OT Class Visits Bionic: A Day of Learning and Inspiration

Bionic recently had the pleasure of hosting the inaugural class from Valparaiso University's Occupational Therapy Program, marking a significant milestone in fostering future therapists. The students were immersed in a series of hands-on activities that provided them with a deeper understanding of orthotics and prosthetics. This interactive experience not only enriched their knowledge but also offered practical insights into the complexities of the field.

Adding to the event's impact, an inspiring guest speaker who is an amputee shared their journey, offering valuable perspectives and motivation to the students. The day was a testament to Bionic's commitment to educational excellence and collaboration. We are eagerly anticipating the opportunity to welcome next year's class and continue supporting the growth of future occupational therapists.

Contents:

1 Bionic News
2 Fabrication Spotlight
3 Clinic Spotlight
4-6 Bionic New Hires
7 Calendar & Recipe
8 Employee of the Month
9 Title

Fabrication Spotlight









Clinic Spotlight

Philadelphia, PA



Our Philadelphia clinic is home to a dedicated team of professionals who are committed to providing exceptional orthotic and prosthetic care. The team includes Robert Chorba (COF), Richard Toal (CO), Neha Chaudhary (Resident), Anjali Patel (Resident), and Michael Meramo (CPO), with Nancy Francart (Regional Admin Manager) ensuring smooth administrative operations. This diverse group brings together a wealth of knowledge and experience, working collaboratively to deliver personalized and innovative solutions for each patient. Their dedication to excellence and patient-centered approach makes our Philadelphia clinic a vital part of the Bionic family.

Bionic New Hires

Dragana Petrovic
Clinic Office Administrator
Bowling Green, KY

Krisler Piodos
Administrative Assistant
Business Center, Merrillville, IN

Payton Leffingwell
Resident
San Antonio, TX

Tamika Cloe
Clinic Office Administrator
Bolingbrook, IL

Nicholas Gardner
Resident, Board Eligible Orthotist
Joliet, IL

Bionic New Hires cont'd

Latoshia Toplin

Clinic Office Administrator

Mishawaka, IN

Jennifer Case

Clinic Office Administrator

Cincinnati, OH

Welcome to the Team!

August 2024

Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
				1	2	3
4	5	6	7	8	9	10
11	12	13	14	15	16	17
18	19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30	31

-No Bake-

Strawberry Cheesecake Pops

Time: 8 hrs

Yield: 14 Pops

Recipe:



Employee of the Month: Kendle Nagy!

"I would like to nominate Kendle for Employee of the Month. Kendle has shown exceptional dedication and diligence in her role in handling authorization and billing for the Florida region. Her manager and team members have highlighted her outstanding performance in ensuring patient files are compliant, assisting other administrators, and consistently preparing ahead for patient appointments. Kendle's proactive approach ensures that patient files are always ready on time before we see patients for evaluations or deliveries. Kendle's dedication and hard work is greatly appreciated."



Great Job!





-Tips-

1. Early to bed, early to rise

Getting back into a school sleep schedule won't happen overnight! A few weeks before school starts, get your child into the habit of going to bed earlier. Gentle winding-down activities such as bath time and reading before bed can help your child relax.

2. Re-establish a routine

Establishing a consistent routine is important for kids. Write out the steps in the routine and rehearse them with your child. In the evening, this could include doing homework, playtime, brushing their teeth, having a bath, and reading before bed.

3. Encourage independence

Children who play an active role in preparing for back to school – such as choosing and organizing school supplies and new clothes – are more likely to get excited about going back to school, which in turn eases their jitters. Is your child old enough for chores like emptying the dishwasher or making lunches? Daily, age-appropriate tasks will help your child gain independence and confidence.

4. Choose the right backpack

Backpacks that are too heavy or worn improperly could result in muscle strain, headaches, and neck pain. Try to choose a backpack made of sturdy, lightweight fabric with wide, padded straps that will support your child's shoulders. Watch that they don't sling it over just one shoulder.

5. Talk about safety

Review outdoor safety rules – things like looking both ways before crossing the street, taking the same route every day if they are walking, familiarizing themselves with crosswalk rules, and being cautious in talking to strangers.

6. Establish healthy habits

Involve your children in choosing and preparing healthy lunches and snacks. Help them find physical activities they enjoy. Take them shopping for healthy snacks and lunch items they can pack themselves. Try to stick to regular meal times.

7. Limit screen time

Back to school is the perfect opportunity to re-establish screen time limits. Why not have the whole family "unplug" in the evenings before bedtime? Choose a spot where everybody can charge their devices overnight. Use an alarm clock instead of a cellphone to wake up in the mornings.

8. Map it out

If your kids are starting at a new school, practice walking or driving to the bus stop or to the school building a week or two before school starts. You could even play in the school playground before school starts. This creates fun memories associated with the school before summer vacation ends.

9. Talk about first-week jitters

Reassure your child that being nervous is natural – even for teachers. You can help your child cope with these feelings when you:

- Let them express their fears. Perhaps you can offer stories of your own first-day jitters when you were a child.
- Teach them to breathe deeply and slowly to calm their nerves.
- Discuss the scenarios that worry them. For example, if they're worried about who to sit with or talk to on the first day, help them plan a strategy and rehearse it so they'll know what to do.

10. Celebrate the start of a new school year

If you celebrate the first day of school, your kids will see back-to-school as a transition they can really enjoy. Try a back-to-school party the day before school starts, complete with cake, balloons and educational gifts. And don't forget to take a picture on the front step in their first-day-of-school outfits. It's going to be a great year!